

WEEK 4 · IT PROCUREMENT

The laptop is the cheap part.

Buying the hardware is day one. The years after it, running and securing the fleet, are where the cost lives.

INSIDE

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Why the purchase price is the smallest part of owning a device, and how to plan the whole lifecycle from day one.

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INTRODUCTION

The invoice is only day one.

A device fleet is judged at purchase on price. It is paid for over its whole life: every set-up, support call, security update, repair and, finally, a safe and certified retirement.

Price is visible

The purchase cost is on one invoice, so it gets the scrutiny.

Running cost is scattered

Support, repairs and lost hours are spread across teams and budgets, so they rarely get added up.

Risk is the hidden cost

An unpatched, unencrypted or badly retired device can cost more than the fleet itself.

01

PART 01

Plan the whole life.

Every device passes through the same stages. Each one has a cost and an owner.

01 The device lifecycle

02 Deploy, support, secure, retire

03 Buying vs managing

THE LIFECYCLE

Six stages, one fleet

Plan each stage before you buy, and the purchase decision changes.

Buy

Choose devices against real roles and refresh cycles, not just the unit price.

Deploy

Image, enrol, ship and get each person productive from their first day.

Support

Handle tickets, faults and warranty claims without people waiting on a fix.

Secure

Patch, encrypt, protect and know where every device is.

Retire

Wipe data to a certified standard, then recycle or resell responsibly.

> **Ask of every quote: what happens to this device after it arrives?**

01



Deploy

Getting a device from the box into a productive person's hands.

THE WORK

Imaging, enrolment into management tools, shipping and first-day set-up.

HIDDEN COST

Engineer time per device, and the hours a new starter waits to begin.

ASK YOURSELF

Who sets up a new starter's device today, and how long does it take?

GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Devices arrive ready to use, enrolled and secured, wherever the person works.



OWNER

IT service desk

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

02



Support and repair

Keeping people working when hardware fails.

THE WORK

Tickets, diagnosis, warranty claims, repairs and swap-out devices.

HIDDEN COST

Lost working hours while people wait, and engineer time chasing warranty.

ASK YOURSELF

What happens when a laptop fails the day before a deadline?

GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A clear repair or replace route, with a spare ready to go.



OWNER

IT support lead

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

03



Secure

Every device is a door into your business.

THE WORK

Patching, disk encryption, endpoint protection and a plan for loss or theft.

HIDDEN COST

The impact of a breach that starts on one unmanaged device.

ASK YOURSELF

Could you prove every device is encrypted and up to date today?

GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Central reporting that shows compliance across the whole fleet at a glance.



OWNER

Security owner

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

04



Retire

The end of life is where data leaks and value is lost.

THE WORK

Certified data wiping, collection, responsible recycling or resale, and refresh planning.

HIDDEN COST

Devices stored in cupboards, data left on drives, and residual value thrown away.

ASK YOURSELF

Where do your old devices go, and what is still on them?

GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A certificate for every wiped device, and value recovered where possible.



OWNER

IT and compliance

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

TWO APPROACHES

Buying devices vs managing a fleet

The same hardware, two very different ways to own it.

	BUYING DEVICES	MANAGING A FLEET
Focus	Unit price at purchase.	Total cost and risk across the device's life.
Set-up	Done in-house, device by device.	Planned, repeatable and ready on arrival.
Support	Handled as tickets come in.	Agreed repair and replacement routes.
Security	Checked when there is time.	Reported centrally and continuously.
End of life	Often an afterthought.	Certified wiping, recycling or resale, planned up front.

BEFORE YOU BUY

Questions to ask any supplier

Use these to compare offers on the whole lifecycle, not just the price per device.

ABOUT THE DEVICES

- ? How will these devices be set up and delivered to our people?
- ? What is the repair and replacement route, and how fast is it?
- ? How long will this model be supported with updates?

ABOUT THE LIFECYCLE

- ? How do you report on security and compliance across the fleet?
- ? What happens to devices at end of life, and do we get certificates?
- ? Can you recover value from devices we retire?

CHECKLIST

Before you sign the order

Tick each one before the purchase goes ahead.

- [ ] **Devices matched to roles**
  Not one model for everyone by default.

- [ ] **Deployment plan agreed**
  Who sets up, how, and how quickly.

- [ ] **Support and repair route defined**
  Including spares and warranty handling.

- [ ] **Security baseline set**
  Encryption, patching and protection from day one.

- [ ] **End-of-life plan agreed**
  Certified wiping and recycling or resale.

- [ ] **Refresh cycle planned**
  So the next purchase is a plan, not a surprise.

TRANSPUTEC

Plan the lifecycle, not just the purchase.

From supply to secure retirement, one partner can manage the whole fleet for you.

Talk to our procurement team

transputec.com